	2000		2016	
China	*India*		*China*	*India*
Bangladesh	902	753	15 157	6 327
Maldives	2	39	344	298
Myanmar	514	257	13 360	2 460
Nepal	171	453	883	4 897
Sri Lanka	269	694	4 260	5 161

Sources: OEC (2018) The Observatory of Economic Complexity, country data, available at https://atlas.media.mit.edu/en/profile/country/; National Bureau of Statistics of China (2001) *China Statistical Yearbook 2001*, Beijing, available at www.stats.gov.cn/english/statisticaldata/annualdata/

There is nonetheless reason to ask if China in the post–Cold War setting, with its main priorities set on building wealth, to some degree neglected India or simply did not take India seriously.[81] As outlined previously, despite India being a major power bordering China, Beijing's geostrategy and foreign policy were in the 1990s and 2000s geared towards other priorities. Debating its post–Cold War strategy, Beijing was not convinced that India would be as strategically significant for China as other major powers,[82] and China may have underestimated Indian concerns about its rise.[83]

China and India in a "new era"

Over the last decade, and in particular since Xi Jinping came to power in 2012, China has pursued a more assertive foreign policy, and its rivalry with the United States has intensified. With the United States occupying the top position of foreign policy priorities in Beijing,[84] one could expect Beijing's relative neglect of India to continue. However, it is actually the opposite scenario unfolding, with India now